Austrian Foreign Policy Panel (AFP3) Dataset

Documentation, Version 3.0

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Overall Project Goals and Funding

The Austrian Foreign Policy Panel Project (AFP3) is a survey project of the University of Innsbruck and the Federal Ministry for European and International Affairs (BMEIA) of the Republic of Austria. The project examines the level of knowledge as well as the attitudes and preferences of the Austrian population in the realm of foreign policy and international relations. It covers a broad range of issue-areas such as security policy, neutrality, foreign trade, migration and digitalization as well as Austria's status in the world and its relations to other countries. The survey is designed as a continuous long-term panel, in which one survey wave is carried out every year to identify long-term developments and the effects of current developments.

Survey Design

Around 3,000 Austrian citizens above the age of 18 are surveyed every year using a web-based (CAWI) questionnaire. Survey participants are selected through (non-probability) quota sampling.

Survey participants were provided by the commercial survey firm Marketagent from their online panel. Marketagent compensates their participation through a reward scheme that allocates points redeemable for cash or with retailers. Compensation is said to adhere to local standards of fair pay (e.g. above local minimum wage regulations). Upon entering the Marketagent pool of survey participants, detailed information is given about the purpose and scope of studies in which respondents may be invited to participate as well as the rights of respondents.

We used Qualtrics as survey software. During the survey and experiment, Qualtrics stores observations for the defined variables on each subject on secure server space made accessible after the conclusion of the survey only to the authors. After the experiment is conducted, the data of respondents' decisions, already excluding any identifying information, is transferred to the authors' computers. Since no connection is established to the recorded data, confidentiality of the individual respondent is guaranteed. Even though data is provided on the respondent-level, no identifying information is provided; respondents are assigned a random number to keep track of the data produced in the survey and survey experiment.

The sample included 3,005 survey participants in the first wave (2023), 3,461 participants in the second wave (2024), and 3,138 participants in the third wave (2025). It was collected using crossed quotas for age and gender as well as simple quotas for region (Bundesland) to achieve representative draws of the population.

The first wave was fielded in June and July of 2023, the second wave in June and July 2024 and the third wave in June and July 2025.

Data Cleaning

We translated the dataset from German to English combining manual translation and using the googleLanguageR-package (see https://docs.ropensci.org/googleLanguageR/). Due to this approach, some German expressions may still exist in the English version of the dataset. Furthermore, we checked the open answers for cases of "incivility", coded these cases with the term "[incivility]", and replaced personally identifiable information with "[personal data]". We also standardized misspelled terms, such as "Schwallenberg" instead of "Schallenberg". We did so by filtering unique terms and exchanging them with the correct spelling.

From initially 3,559 observations from survey participants in wave 1 (2023) who clicked the Marketagent invitation link, we removed those survey participants that did not consent (n=81), those from survey participants who attempted to take the survey more than once (n=248), and those survey participants who did not finish the full survey (n=225), leaving us with 3,005 observations from unique survey participants.

From initially 4,551 observations from survey participants in wave 2 (2024) who clicked the Marketagent invitation link, we removed those survey participants that did not consent (n=85), those who attempted to take the survey more than once (n=743, we kept the first attempt), and those who did not finish the full survey (n=262), leaving us with 3,461 observations from unique survey participants.

From initially 3,485 observations from survey participants in wave 3 (2025) who clicked the Marketagent invitation link, we removed 143 observations from those survey participants who attempted to take the survey more than once, from those survey participants that did not consent (n=46) and those survey participants who did not finish the full survey (n=158), leaving us with 3,138 observations from unique survey participants.

What has changed from the wave 2024 to the wave 2025?

In version 3.0 all remaining spelling and grammar errors that appeared in version 2.0 have been corrected. Minor adjustments of formulations were made to selected items to enhance clarity without altering the original meaning of the questions or answers. For a detailed comparison, all questions and answers from both version 2.0 and 3.0 are listed. The following table provides an overview of specific changes that go beyond the adjustments mentioned above.

Items	Description
Item 01: consent_text	Change from "Die Umfrage sollte nicht mehr als 20 Minuten Ihrer Zeit in Anspruch nehmen. [en: The survey should take no more than 20 minutes of your time.]" to "Die Umfrage sollte nicht mehr als 25 Minuten Ihrer Zeit in Anspruch nehmen. [en: The survey should take no more than 25 minutes of your time.]".
Item 09: education	Change from "Doktor / PhD [en: Doctor / PhD]" to "Doktor/PhD [en: Doctor/PhD]".
Item 12: netincome	Change from "Wie hoch ist das monatliche Netto-Einkommen Ihres Haushaltes (also aller Personen mit Hauptwohnsitz in Ihrer Wohneinheit)? Rechnen Sie bitte alle Einkommen zusammen inklusive etwaige Beihilfen, Zusatzleistungen, Kinderbeihilfe, Arbeitslosenunterstützung etc. [en: No change in the English version: What is your household's monthly net income (including all persons with their primary residence in your household)? Please add up all income including any allowances, additional benefits, child benefits, unemployment benefits, etc.]" to "Wie hoch ist das monatliche Netto-Einkommen Ihres Haushaltes (also aller Personen mit Hauptwohnsitz in Ihrer Wohneinheit)? Rechnen Sie bitte alle Einkommen zusammen inklusive etwaiger Beihilfen, Zusatzleistungen, Kinderbeihilfe, Arbeitslosenunterstützung etc.".

Items	Description
Item 21: election_choice_2024	Change from "Welche Partei haben Sie bei der letzten Nationalratswahl im Jahr 2019 gewählt? [en: Which party did you vote for in the last election for the National Council in 2019?]" to "Welche Partei haben Sie bei der letzten Nationalratswahl im Jahr 2024 gewählt? [Which party did you vote for in the last election for the National Council in 2024?]", addition of answer option "Bierpartei [en: Beer Party]" and change of item name from "election_choice_2019" to "election_choice_2024".
Item 25: identity	Answer option "Prefer not to say" removed.
Item 32: fparty_association	Addition of answer option "KPÖ".
Item 33: party_competence	Addition of answer option "KPÖ".
Item 39: state_influence_	Change from "Weltpolitik [en: world politics]" to "internationalen Politik [en: international politics]".
Item 48: security_challenges2_	Change from "Politische Instabilität [no change in the English version: Political instability]" to "politische Instabilität".
Item 61: austria_reputation	Change from "Neutral [en: No change in the English version: Neither good nor bad]" to "Weder gut noch schlecht".
Item 72: trade_agreements_eu	Change from "Welcher der folgenden Aussagen über die Handelsabkommen der EU stimmen Sie am meisten zu? [en: Which of the following statements about the EU's trade agreements do you agree with most?]" to "Welchen der folgenden Aussagen über die Handelsabkommen der EU stimmen Sie am meisten zu (Mehrfachnennung möglich)? [en: Which of the following statements about the EU's trade agreements do you agree with most? (multiple answers possible)]", allowing multiple answers and randomizing of answer options.
Item 82: EU_election_choice	Removed from version 3.0.
Item 83: EU_enlargement	Removed from version 3.0.
Item 84: EU_enlargement_	Removed from version 3.0.
Item 82: ending	Replacement from item 85 to 82.
Item 83: testQuestion	Replacement from item 86 to 83.

Dataset Details

This dataset comprises twelve files:

- this documentation (10827_mr_en_v3_0.html and 10827_mr_en_v3_0.pdf),
- the German version of the dataset (10827_da_de_v3_0.csv, 10827_da_de_v3_0.dta, 10827_da_de_v3_0.zsav),
- the English version of the dataset (10827_da_en_v3_0.csv, 10827_da_en_v3_0.dta, 10827_da_en_v3_0.zsav),
- the German version of the survey instrument (i.e., questionnaire) (10827_qu_de_v3_0.pdf),
- the English version of the survey instrument (i.e., questionnaire) (10827_qu_en_v3_0.pdf),
- the German version of the codebook (10827_co_de_v3_0.pdf),
- and the English version of the codebook (10827_co_en_v3_0.pdf).

Contact

If you have any questions concerning the dataset, please do not hesitate to contact us via eMail (franz.eder@uibk.ac.at).

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Suggested Citation

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